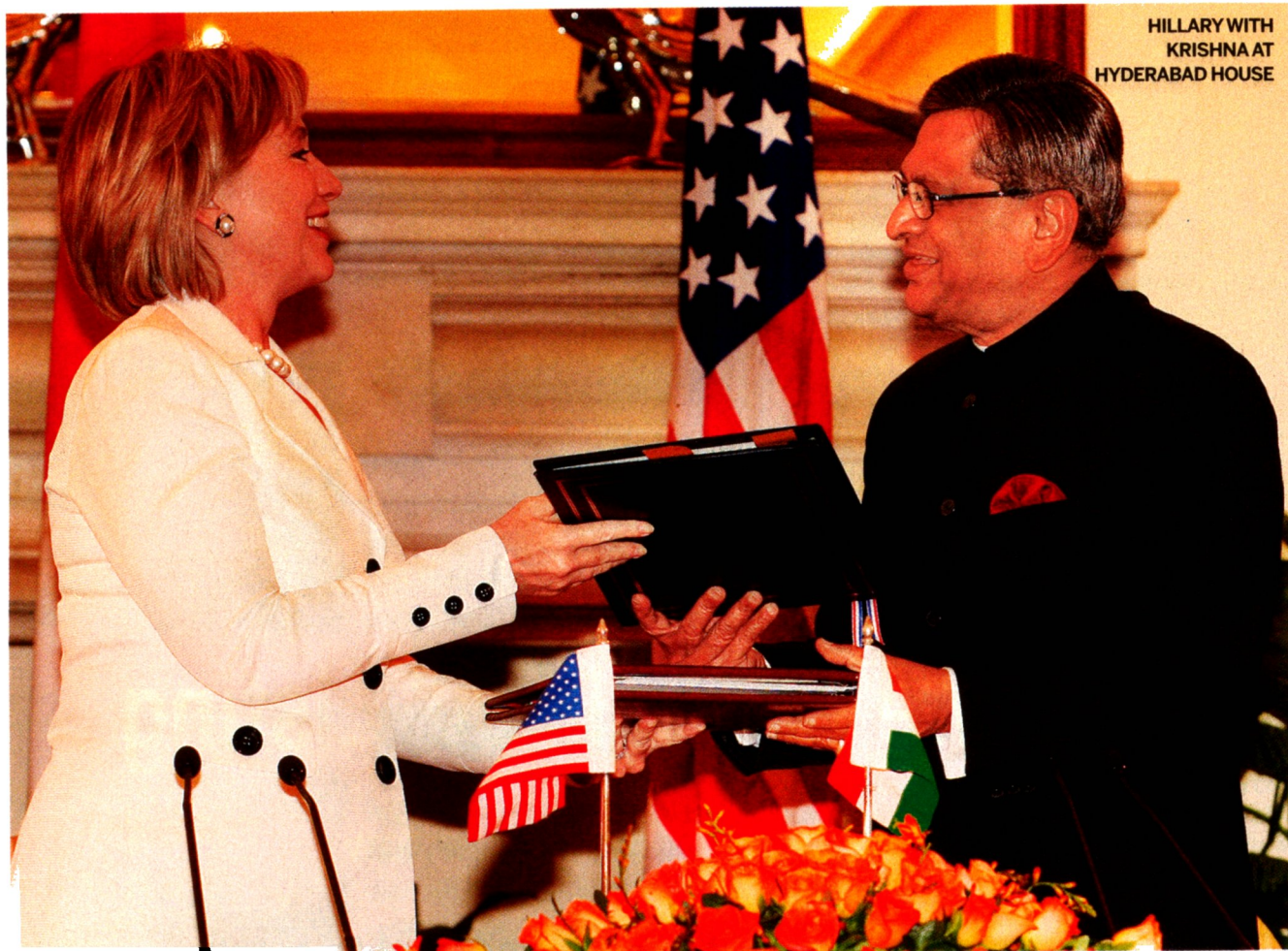




HILLARY WITH
KRISHNA AT
HYDERABAD HOUSE

SIPRA DAS

FALLING SHORT

Hillary Clinton's first visit to India as secretary of state came amid a lot of hype and a promise to take the Indo-US relationship to a new level but little was delivered

| By Saurabh Shukla |

Hillary Clinton was at her charming best when she touched down in New Delhi on July 19 to mend ties and deepen the engagement between India and the US, and in her own words, to take it to the new level 3.0. In her first visit to India as the US secretary of state, Hillary, 62, has come a long way from being the Mrs Bill Clinton that India had first greeted in 1995. Her

visit was aimed at providing an action-oriented template of bilateral relationship. The timing of the visit was crucial as the relationship had slowed down after being on a high post the Indo-US nuclear deal under the Republican regime of George W. Bush. But even with all the charm and hype around it, the visit fell short of addressing India's concerns.

The former Yale-educated lawyer had the right words for the right meetings—praising Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's leadership and complimenting him for the nuclear deal.